DATA QUALITY GUIDE

Data Validation and Discrepancy Resolution Guidelines

GUIDE 01 | v1.0 | November 10, 2026

Use these controls to decide whether a provider record or enrollment application can move forward. Preserve what each source reported, hold affected work when the evidence is incomplete, and document who cleared the issue.

Portfolio simulation. All case records, evidence references, owners and operating controls are illustrative.

Record and field validation

Keep intake and source values unchanged. Use separate comparison fields to trim spaces, standardize case and parse dates. Store identifiers as text so leading zeroes survive. Retain suffixes, punctuation and source status wording in the raw fields.

Field	Validation rule	Evidence and action
Provider identity and NPI	Require a provider key and name. For an NPI, check for 10 digits, then confirm entity type and name in NPPES. Compare taxonomy and location in context.	NPPES supports identity comparison. Use the relevant board for licensure and the credentialing file for the credentialing decision.
License and board	Compare board, jurisdiction, license type and number together. Record the board name, displayed status, expiration and any visible restrictions.	Use the issuing board. With similar names, corroborate using the license number and other permitted identifiers. Escalate unresolved ambiguity.
Dates and status	Use real date values with a consistent display. Check expiration against the review date and flag future check dates or impossible stage sequences.	Record missing and inapplicable separately. Preserve the displayed board status and use a separate internal disposition.
CME evidence	For an assigned review, compare participant, activity, completion date, credit and issuer against the scoped requirement.	Use the applicable board guidance and available course evidence. Log a missing certificate as missing evidence. Keep the review open.
Enrollment identity and stage	Match the provider, payer, program, action and applicable entity or location. Check signatory authority and evidence for the current stage.	Use the payer or contractor channel. Capture the submission receipt and the decision separately. Record the effective date from authoritative evidence.

Triage and resolve exceptions

Open an exception for each affected check. Record the internal record ID, field, submitted value, source value, source URL, access date and time zone, evidence pointer, severity, owner, next action and due date. Include the affected applications. Use a secure evidence store for underlying files.

Severity and example	Immediate action	Closure evidence
Critical Wrong entity, expired or restricted license, possible adverse action	Hold affected verification or submission. Route to the team lead for review and to the client's designated decision maker when required.	Authoritative response or record plus documented disposition from the designated reviewer. Recheck any dependent cases.
Blocking No reliable match, missing required evidence, unsigned attestation	Keep the affected item open. Request the specific missing item or ask the board or payer to clarify. Give the owner a dated follow-up.	Documented match, required item or authorized signature. A second reviewer confirms clearance before release under the sample controls.
Review Formatting variance or plausible name change	Compare raw values and supporting identifiers. Route a substantive name change through the appropriate correction channel.	Evidence shows the same entity. Log the comparison, any approved correction, and the reviewer's conclusion.

Record an evidence outcome

Distinguish a match, a mismatch, no result and source unavailability. Document the query criteria and source response. For a no-result, recheck jurisdiction, entity type and search terms. For an outage, record the failed attempt and retry time. Use the board's verification channel when online evidence is ambiguous.

Review the correction before releasing work

Log the previous and corrected value, reason, evidence pointer, actor and timestamp. Confirm the correction in the governing source when a source-side update is required. Re-run affected checks and have a second reviewer confirm blocking or critical resolution. Release the affected application only after the reviewer records the decision and required evidence is present.

Duplicate handling

Check the intended record scope before merging. One provider can have several licenses and applications. Use provider + jurisdiction + board + license type + license number for a license candidate match. For enrollment, include program, action, relevant entity or location, and cycle. Route potential duplicates to a reviewer before updating either record.

Track due dates separately

Keep the internal follow-up date, external response deadline and next owner separate. Use the notice or governing instructions for an external deadline. Escalate an overdue internal action or approaching external deadline through the assigned queue and log the escalation.

Worked example and release review

Synthetic case PRV-001 covers Dr. Rowan Vale, a fictional California physician. The evidence outcomes below describe the workbook exercise. Source references explain where an analyst would research the same type of issue in live work.

Record	Initial exercise state	Action and clearance evidence
VER-001	California license match on November 6, 2026 in the simulation.	Retain the mock board result and check date. Preserve board status separately from the internal match decision.
VER-002	NPI identity match on November 6, 2026 in the simulation.	Retain the mock registry result and entity match. Keep licensure evidence on VER-001.
VER-003	Course completion certificate missing from the client's renewal readiness review.	Request the certificate through the secure portal with a November 12, 2026 follow-up. Compare participant, course and completion details, and log the evidence reference and review.
ENR-001	Medicare Part B individual application received November 5. On hold November 10 under the sample client's filing policy.	Resolve VER-003 and record reviewer clearance before releasing the simulated filing hold. Confirm submission and any decision with separate evidence.

Release review checklist

Confirm the record and application IDs, current source evidence, required attestations, resolved blockers, reviewer decision and next owner. Check the deadline and recipient channel. Reopen affected records if new evidence changes the result. Limit the case log to fields needed to reproduce the decision.

Official references

Accessed November 10, 2026. Linked titles open the source URLs.

CMS NPPES NPI Registry. Lists public data for active NPI records. CMS expressly limits what issuance establishes about licensure and credentialing.

Medical Board of California Physician License Lookup Disclosure. Explains which California physician records are publicly visible and how to request additional information. Some details are unavailable online.

Medical Board of California Continuing Medical Education. Explains CME documentation and the Board's audit process. This guidance covers the Board's licensees. The sample client's certificate check is a separate procedure.

CMS Medicare Provider Enrollment MLN9658742. Explains Provider Enrollment, Chain, and Ownership System (PECOS) status checks and Medicare Administrative Contractor (MAC) approval letters for Medicare. Other payers have their own evidence and workflows.

HHS Minimum Necessary Requirement. Describes the HIPAA Privacy Rule's minimum necessary standard for protected health information where applicable, including exceptions. The secure-channel steps in this portfolio are sample operations controls.